

Employee Handbook

Company: [Company Name] | Effective Date: [Insert Date] | Policy Owner: Human Resources / Finance

Purpose: This sample policy is designed for internal company use and should be reviewed and adapted to local laws, tax rules, employment requirements, and company-specific practices before adoption.

1. Welcome and Handbook Purpose

Welcome to [Company Name]. This handbook summarizes important workplace practices, expectations, and resources. It is intended to help employees understand how we work together and where to find guidance when questions arise.

This handbook is not an employment contract and does not guarantee employment for any specific duration. Employment terms are subject to applicable law and any signed agreement that specifically governs the employee.

2. Equal Employment Opportunity and Respectful Workplace

[Company Name] is committed to equal employment opportunity and a workplace free from unlawful discrimination, harassment, and retaliation. Employment decisions are based on legitimate business and job-related factors.

- Harassment, bullying, threats, intimidation, and discriminatory conduct are not acceptable.
- Employees should report concerns to a manager, HR, another designated reporting channel, or any alternative channel provided by the company.
- The company will review concerns promptly and as confidentially as practical.

3. Employment Records and Personal Information

Employees are responsible for keeping required personal and employment information current, including contact information, emergency contact, tax forms, work authorization, and benefit information. The company handles employee records in accordance with applicable privacy and records laws.

4. Working Hours, Attendance, and Timekeeping

Employees are expected to report to work on time, follow assigned schedules, and communicate promptly about absences or delays. Non-exempt or hourly employees must record all working time accurately and may not work off the clock.

Meal periods, rest breaks, overtime, and scheduling practices will follow applicable law and local company procedures.

5. Compensation and Payroll

Employees are paid according to the company's payroll schedule and applicable wage laws. Employees should review pay statements and report suspected errors promptly. Required and authorized deductions may be made from pay as permitted by law.

6. Benefits

Eligible employees may participate in benefit programs such as health coverage, retirement savings, life or disability insurance, wellness programs, paid time off, and other offerings. Formal plan documents control if there is any difference between this handbook and a benefit plan.

7. Leave and Time Off

Vacation/PTO, sick leave, family and medical leave, parental leave, bereavement, jury duty, military leave, and other absences are governed by the Leave Policy, benefit plans, and applicable law. Employees should contact HR for location-specific rights and eligibility.

8. Remote and Hybrid Work

Employees approved for remote or hybrid work must follow the Remote Work Policy. Remote arrangements may depend on role requirements, security, performance, collaboration needs, and approved work location.

9. Travel and Business Expenses

Business travel and expense reimbursement are governed by the Travel Policy and Expense Policy. Employees must obtain required approvals, use company funds responsibly, provide accurate documentation, and avoid personal or unapproved charges.

10. Standards of Conduct

Employees are expected to act professionally, ethically, safely, and respectfully. Examples of conduct that may lead to corrective action include dishonesty, fraud, insubordination, violence, harassment, theft, serious safety violations, misuse of confidential information, and intentional damage to company property.

The company may use coaching, warnings, performance plans, suspension, termination, or other corrective action depending on the circumstances and applicable law. Nothing in this section limits legally protected employee activity.

11. Conflicts of Interest and Outside Activities

Employees should avoid situations where personal interests conflict, or appear to conflict, with company responsibilities. Potential conflicts involving vendors, customers, competitors, investments, family relationships, gifts, outside employment, or business opportunities should be disclosed to the appropriate company contact.

Outside work is generally permitted when it does not interfere with company duties, misuse company resources, violate confidentiality, or create a conflict of interest.

12. Confidentiality, Privacy, and Intellectual Property

Employees must protect confidential company, customer, employee, and business-partner information. Access should be limited to legitimate business need. Intellectual property created within the scope of employment is handled according to applicable law and signed agreements.

Nothing in this policy is intended to prohibit employees from discussing wages, hours, or working conditions or from engaging in any activity protected by law.

13. Technology and Acceptable Use

Company technology is provided primarily for business use. Limited personal use may be allowed when it is lawful, reasonable, secure, and does not interfere with work. Employees must follow security requirements, protect

passwords, use multi-factor authentication where required, and report suspected phishing, malware, data loss, or account compromise promptly.

- Do not install unauthorized software or use unapproved cloud services for company data.
- Do not use company systems for unlawful, harassing, discriminatory, fraudulent, or materially disruptive activity.

14. Social Media and Public Communications

Employees should make clear when personal social media views are their own and must not disclose confidential information or claim to speak for the company unless authorized. Media, investor, legal, and official public inquiries should be directed to designated company representatives.

This policy does not restrict legally protected speech or employee rights under applicable law.

15. Health, Safety, Violence Prevention, and Substance Rules

Employees must follow safety procedures, report hazards and injuries, and cooperate with emergency rules. Violence, credible threats, intimidation, and possession of prohibited weapons are not permitted to the extent allowed by law and company policy.

Employees must not work while impaired in a manner that creates a safety, performance, or legal risk. Drug and alcohol testing, where used, will be administered only in accordance with applicable law and company procedures.

16. Workplace Relationships and Professional Boundaries

Employees should maintain professional boundaries and avoid favoritism, conflicts of interest, or supervisory relationships that could create concerns about fairness. Romantic or close personal relationships that create an actual or potential reporting-line conflict should be disclosed as required by company policy.

17. Reporting Concerns and Non-Retaliation

Employees are encouraged to raise good-faith concerns about policy violations, unlawful conduct, fraud, safety, harassment, discrimination, financial controls, or other workplace issues. Reports may be made to a manager, HR, Legal, Compliance, or another available reporting channel.

Retaliation against anyone who raises a good-faith concern, participates in an investigation, requests an accommodation, or exercises protected rights is prohibited.

18. Separation from Employment

At the end of employment, employees must return company property, protect confidential information, complete required transition steps, and provide updated contact details when needed for final documents. Final pay, benefit continuation, unused leave payout, and access termination will be handled according to applicable law and company policy.

19. Acknowledgment

Employees may be asked to acknowledge receipt of this handbook and related policies. Acknowledgment confirms receipt and understanding of where policies are located; it does not create a contract or waive legal rights.

Employee Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Policy Administration: Questions about this policy should be directed to the policy owner. [Company Name] may revise this policy at any time, subject to applicable law and required notice.